office of the spiritual leader. In this reality, the question is how much influence the IRGC will have on the nuclear decision-making process, not to mention on potential nuclear activity.

Even if the Iranians agree to transfer part of their stockpile of LEU (low-enriched uranium) abroad to continue enrichment, as long as this option is consistent with the projected Iranian course of progress, it will be preceded by long and exhausting negotiations on the conditions and arrangements for verification, and afterwards it will not even be possible to ensure that they do not continue to secretly enrich the LEU by themselves. Regarding the timetable, the working assumption is that they will not reach breakout capacity until they have enough material for at least ten bombs. That is, even if the Iranians agree to such an arrangement, they will not give up their desire to acquire nuclear weapons.

The events surrounding the 2009 Iranian elections only boosted the regime's determination to march forward with the nuclear program. The regime's assessment was that American pressure or an American "green light" for Israeli military action should not be feared. They judged that their determination to continue progress on the program would strengthen the regime. There is evidence that the North Korean case served as a model for Iran. If this is true, one could expect that Iran, in its negotiations with the United States and Europe, would reach understandings and then withdraw from them in order to extract further concessions. Indeed, in the negotiations between Iran and the United States and the other world powers, there were signs that the Iranians had learned from North Korea's patterns of behavior.

Another lesson from the North Korean case is that Iran would prefer to demonstrate its capability on the basis of the assumption that there will be no rollback, so if it crosses the line (that is, carries out an experiment or otherwise demonstrates its military nuclear capability) it will have achieved the desired status, and the subsequent discussions will be about a freeze and avoiding the repetition of a similar experiment.

Here it is worth examining the North Korean case and its implications for Iran's behavior during the Trump era. Perhaps we should start from the end (just before the summit of Trump and Kim in June 2018) and say that Trump's "strategy," expressed via tweetstorms and frenetic, spontaneous statements from every stage, including the 2017 UN General Assembly, is already steering the North Korean leader even further toward brinkmanship.